You're the closest to heaven that I'll ever be

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/59770420.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Catra - Relationship

Characters:
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Additional Tags:
Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Hurt/Comfort, Late Night Conversations, Mentioned Horde Prime (She-Ra), Mentioned Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Cuddling & Snuggling, No Lesbians Die, Idiots in Love, My First Work in This Fandom, no beta we die like shadow weaver, I'm nervous about this, be nice, Post Season 5, Catra Redemption

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You're the closest to heaven that I'll ever be

by Lord_of_the_Cookie

Summary

After Horde Prime's defeat, Catra is still haunted, but now she has the chance to start anew together with Adora.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

The magic roared from behind them. The very air vibrated around the Heart as the sickly green light crept closer and closer. Then, a whisper.

"Little sister…"

It wormed into her ears, her heart, just like the veins of green overtaking the surrounding world. The prideful voice was filled with triumphant pleasure in every word.

"...How truly disappointing. All your efforts were for naught and now you can only regret. Regret that you ever left my light."

It filled her with dread. It made her sick. But it was alright now. He would never get his hands on the Heart. Because-

"Cat… ra. I'm so…"

Something was wrong. The whimper of an all too familiar voice barely reached her ears and then was heard no more. The last words were filled with pain.

She looked down only to see Adora, her face scarred by the sickly green veins. Her eyes lifeless. Her whole body eerily still and unmoving in Catra's arms.

It couldn't be. A pit formed in her stomach. The light burned and the humming of the Heart felt overpowering. Everything felt so wrong. A cry of agony formed in her chest only to become stuck, unable to escape through her mouth that felt petrified just like the rest of her body.

"My, my, yet another disappointment. Truly, I expected someone as stubborn as her to cling to life longer. But it seems even the almighty She-Ra cannot stand against my might."

She could not say anything. Her eyes stung as tears formed in them. The painful scream rattled inside her chest as it tried to free itself, straining her whole body. She held Adora closer. No

heartbeat. She was gone. Catra could do nothing anymore other than just hold her lifeless love in her embrace, arms shaking uncontrollably while sobs tore themselves out of her throat.

The sickly green reached the Heart at last. The magic roared with greater intensity than before for a brief moment before becoming subdued, shackled under His will. But Catra couldn't bring herself to care anymore. Not now when she let the only person close to her slip away, never to return. Never to speak to her again in her sweet voice. Never to smile again. Never to be there for her again.

"The Heart belongs to me now. As do you, little sister. Prime is ever merciful to those who gave me good service, even if only briefly. Time has come that you returned to my light, sister dearest."

Everything felt blurry. They dragged her away. The tall, pale figures in their white robes. Their bony hands reaching for her from all directions. She kicked, screamed and cried as they separated her from Adora. But she wasn't strong enough to hold on to her.

Then they brought her to the ship. The silent white corridors that seemed to stretch out endlessly filled her vision. She had no strength in her anymore to resist when they forced her into the pool of green. It filled her vision and quickly after, her entire being. The light. The light that burns from the inside. It tore her to pieces just like before. Electricity crackled in the air, accompanying her screams of agony.

She was empty. Completely stripped of everything. His voice then settled into her head again. Gave her some sense of choice. Some sense of acceptance. That this was the best she ever felt. That she wanted this. Weightless. Free. Her heart content, no longer aching with the terrible loss she just suffered. Everything was in its right place. She was with Prime again. Just like she was meant to be. Everything was his to rule, after all. And now that he had

the power of all of Etheria's magic, the entire universe would bow to him and be brought into the undying light of Horde Prim-

"NO!"

She snapped awake. Sweaty, breathing roughly while her heart hammered against her chest. Catra's eyes darted around her surroundings. Bright Moon. She was in Bright Moon and alright. She sat on the bed, looking into the night, knees tucked to her chest. Her fingers traced the back of her neck just to make sure. They only found a small scar.

Melog was already by her side, meowing softly with that nigh ethereal voice of theirs. Eyes full of concern as they looked at her questionably. She smiled and began patting her companion, her lips forming a tiny smile.

"It's alright buddy. I just had a nightmare," her tail coiled around her legs, "just… a nightmare."

Once she calmed down a little, Catra collapsed back on the pillow. Staring at the ceiling that was way higher than she was used to, running her hand through Melog's mane as they snuggled close to her.

Everything ended a day ago. The war that was Catra's whole life, was over. It felt strange. Almost like an irreplaceable part of her was plucked away. She knew that she was supposed to be happy about it, but still, she felt quite hollow when she thought about the fact that most likely there would never be any grandscale fighting again.

After Adora used the power of the Heart to destroy Horde Prime for good, they all returned to Bright Moon to get some rest. They gave Catra a room. Apparently, it was used to hold prisoners during the war. But before that it was a spare room. So, now it's original purpose was restored. When Catra first heard about it, she thought it was only fitting for her to be put into such a room. One that was used to hold the enemies of Bright Moon. But after

seeing it for herself she simply felt stupid. It was the same, overly pink, overly comfortable, as almost every room in the castle.

“This is your idea of a prison cell?” Catra said when she stepped into the room shortly after they returned.

“Hey, we removed the cushions,” Glimmer protested, followed by an awkward silence. “We put them back though. For you.... Okay goodnight.”

With a flash, the Queen of Bright Moon ran away from the awkwardness. Only Catra and Adora remained.

“You sure you don’t wanna, you know, stay in my room? There's a lot of space for both of us,” she offered, looking at Catra as she took her hand into hers.

Catra could only smile at the gesture. She felt at ease just from Adora’s touch, her cheeks ran tiny bit red.

“It’s okay Adora. Maybe in the future but now I need some space to think about it. About everything.”

“Oh, alright. I suppose I’ll see you tomorrow then?”

“You bet, princess.”

Now it was the middle of the night and she regretted not taking Adora’s offer. They confessed love to each other at the Heart of Etheria, moments before their supposed demise. In that moment, she felt the happiest she ever recalled being. And when they shared a kiss, the waves upon waves of ancient magic washing over them, painting the entire world in myriad of vibrant colors. It felt like a dream come true. Because once everything settled down, it did not feel real.

Everything was so close to not working out. Like in the nightmare. If one thing was off, if her words came too late, it was possible the venom would have killed Adora and Prime would succeed. Or, in a different scenario, the Failsafe would activate, but Adora

would not have the strength to transform to She-Ra, and the magic would scorch them both. Then Shadow Weaver would be the one who won. And for Catra, then felt even worse. Adora throwing her life away just because that awful woman pushed her to sacrifice herself.
That awful woman who ended up giving her life so they could live. Catra and Adora. Together

She still did not know how to feel about the whole thing. Maybe she never would. It stung a little, but if anything, Shadow Weaver did one good thing in her life. Removing herself from the picture.

Everything did work out in the end. And that was something to be thankful for. They had all the time in the world now. All the time for…

"What do I do now?" Catra asked in a whisper. Melog raised their head, but the question wasn't directed at him, rather than at Catra herself.

She, quite frankly, had no idea what she wanted to do. People of Etheria sure weren't going to be happy with a Force Captain walking around, even if a former one. It was understandable that most put up with her presence at Adora's request. It was a crisis after all. Yet, she still felt suspicious, judgemental looks on her from time to time. The scattered remains of the Horde were sure to be not any different, if not worse. She worked them to the bone. Extra shift after shift. No sleep, and why? They were just faceless grunts to her at the time. Nothing but means for her to take the rebellion down and bring Adora to her knees. To make her pay for abandoning her.

Now she hated herself for ever thinking like that. The soldiers would not forgive her. Only Adora was dumb enough to not hate Catra even after all the terrible things Catra has done to her and her friends. Nobody was as forgiving as her. Which is exactly why Catra found herself in love with her.

Back then, she forced the growing feelings of affection down. Shadow Weaver barely tolerated Catra being simple friends with Adora. She was just a distraction to her special child, after all. Nothing but a dead weight bringing Adora down. So, Catra pushed it down. The feelings she did not quite understand. Shoved them deep down into her heart before they could blossom, before she could fully grasp what exactly they were.
And then Adora left.

Suddenly, the feelings that became a giant thorn lodged into her heart, were ripped out. Leaving behind a gaping hole that kept bleeding. She tried to cover it up. After all, with Adora gone, she was the one that got the Force Captain position. Not Adora. Then she brought Shadow Weaver down and threw her into a prison where she belonged. It was all going swell. Or so she told herself, while the wound in her heart started festering.

She wanted to make her pay. Everyone else stopped to matter. Only Adora, Adora, Adora. She had to suffer the same pain. No. Worse than that. Once Catra razed Bright Moon and the rest of Etheria to the ground, then Adora would see. See what exactly her betrayal caused. That chasing stupid heroism was nothing more than utter foolishness.

And yet, when everything crumbled away. When her attempts to regain control failed and Horde Prime simply laughed in her face. He saw through her every tactic, her every feeling. It drove her mad with anger at how perfectly he seemed to understand the feelings she did not want to understand well before he forced himself into her head, bent her entire being to his will.

In that moment, it was exactly that stupid heroism that saved her.

She set everything aflame, including herself. But one idiot still ran through the wall of flames. One idiot never once gave up on her. When her life was reduced to nothing but cinders and she breathed her very last breath, that idiot rushed in to bring her back from oblivion. And Catra would never forget that.

“Stay.”

It was then that the feelings started returning. The feelings of warmth as her hand rested in Adora’s. The feeling of hopefully having a place to belong, however small. The hollow that was left behind by the raging inferno of her hate. It began filling up with love. It was always there, no matter how she hid it. No matter how many tiny shards she smashed it into. It persisted, and now it was stronger than ever. Then finally, at the Heart of Etheria, it grew so much that in the moment of desperation, it all began spilling out. And it saved the universe.

Adora.

The girl she grew up with was once again filling her thoughts. But they were much different thoughts now. Catra decided to think it over some other day.

“Come Melog. I think I want to do a sleepover now.”

Even if the whole of Etheria hated her. There was one person who would never even think about hating Catra.

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“Hey, Adora,” Catra slipped into the room, Melog in tow.

“Catra? Didn’t you say you wanted some space to think?” Adora was quickly awake. Catra wondered if she was even sleeping in the first place.

“Well yeah, turns out there wasn’t really much to think about,” she offered her a smug smile, sitting at the edge of Adora’s bed. “So, does your offer still stand, princess?”

Adora smiled back. Her gray blue eyes were filled with kindness, her blonde hair was undone, spilling down around her face and Catra found herself staring. Adora was beautiful, she realized as much. But now, with the light of the moon from the outside framing her face, it felt much different. Magical. Catra felt her cheeks getting redder.

“Of course it still stands. I was actually kinda hoping you would come.”

“Oh? Were you?” Catra asked, breaking from her awe as she struggled to remain composed.

“Mhm,” Adora hummed, causing a chuckle to escape Catra’s mouth.

“I guess I won’t be letting you down.” She curled into a ball at Adora’s feet, just like she used to. It was about the closest she could get to Adora back then, and now she was returned to her rightful place at her side.

Only, Adora was not laying back down.

“Um, Catra,” she nudged her. “Don’t you want to… You see…”

“What?” Catra turned to face the stammering Adora.

“Want to lie next to me? You don’t have to be at my legs. This bed has actual space compared to the ones we had back in the Fright Zone.”

Catra rose up again, staring at Adora.

“I mean, sure. Yeah, that makes sense,” Catra replied, feeling the heat paint her face more and more red as she slowly made her way next to Adora’s side.

Adora held the blanket up and Catra slid under it. They were side by side now. Catra could feel her heartbeat slowly accelerate.

The girl she loved was right next to her. They were actually together. And so close too.

Silence filled the air as they both stared at the ceiling. Only the sound of the waterfall could be heard. Catra’s ears flicked as she focused on the sound of running water. Why did Adora even have

a waterfall inside her room in the first place? Was it for showering?

There was also the sound of Melog's breathing as they dozed off next to the bed.

Then, the sound of a rustling blanket and before she knew it, Adora's arm slipped around her, pulling her into an embrace.

"Wha- Adora?" She looked up only to see that their faces were practically touching, both decorated with a faint blush.

The embrace Catra found herself in was tight, but not too much to be uncomfortable, but tight just enough for Catra to feel the love behind it.

Adora was silent, simply gently smiling. Catra returned the gesture with a smile as well. She could hear Adora's heart beating in unison with her own heart. Her sweet smell made Catra feel so at ease, melting her worries away.

"Wow," she could only say as much.

"Right?" Adora said before kissing Catra's forehead. "You are so cute."

"Hey! I'm not cute."

"Oh, but you are."

Adora giggled, tapping Catra's nose with her finger before kissing her forehead again, making Catra blush even more furiously.

Catra took a deep breath, feeling Adora's scent, her warmth and her love. It felt perfect, it's where she belonged now.

"Fine, I'll let you have it. This time."

She snuggled closer, brushing her cheek against Adora's and put her arms around her as well. Her tail too, absentmindedly coiled

itself around Adora's thigh.

Just as she started pulling away, Adora's hand traced up her back and pulled her head closer into a kiss. Their lips only briefly touched at first, then fully committed to the kiss. Their second kiss.

Everything else stood still for the duration of the kiss. It was simply just both of them, sharing their love and warmth. A shiver of happiness ran through Catra's skin as she deepened the kiss. She wanted more of Adora, she realized. Her hand made its way into her blonde hair, combing through it and then pulling as Adora ran caressed the back of her head with one hand, running the other across her back through the thin layer of fur over her skin.

Their lips separated and Catra pressed her head against Adora's collarbone. She stifled a gasp before she ended the kiss. The pleasure of it was becoming too much too fast. So Catra pulled away, instead just snuggling againsts Adora again. Thanks to them both just wearing the gray shorts and tops, their exposed skin made a lot of contact, filling up Catra's stomach with more of that burning longing she felt for Adora.

It was too early. Maybe in the future, a long way from now. But right now, there was no way that Adora wanted Catra in that way.

"Something wrong?" Adora asked, her voice gentle. She must have noticed how still Catra suddenly went.

"Hmm, nothing. It's just…"

"C'mon," she cooed softly into Catra's ear, making her tail coil tighter. "You can tell me about everything, okay? I'm so sorry for leaving you with the Horde back then three years ago. I sort of… I just threw myself into being the best She-Ra I could be, that I did not realize how much you were hurting before it was too late. I'm so sorry."

Tears formed in Adora's eyes. Their foreheads pressed together as she started crying. Catra moved away a bit so she could wipe the

blonde's tears away. Carefully, as to not release her claws.

"I should have tried harder. Not with the hero stuff, but with getting you out of there. So you wouldn't have to suffer like th-"

Her words were interrupted by another sudden kiss from Catra's side. It was a much quicker kiss than before, but no less loving.

It was their third. Catra kept count, but not that she would ever tell anyone.

"I love you so much," she started, continuing to wipe away Adora's tears and gently caressing her cheek as she purred to calm her down. "It doesn't feel real that you feel the same. That's…" her voice trailed off a little bit as she recomposed. "...That's kinda what I needed to think about. I thought you didn't care about me after you left. Just the fact that I am here with you like this feels like a dream."

"Oh, Catra, I love you too," Adora giggled, her sadness gone as she watched Catra grow redder and redder during her speech. "And you know what else feels like a dream?"

"What? That you are making me say all this embarrassing stuff?"

"Well, that too. But the fact we are here. That it's peace out there now. And that we aren't fighting anymore. It's weird seeing you without that headgear of yours though."

Catra grimaced. "Yeah, pretty sure Prime threw it away like the rest of my stuff when he… When he did what he did."

She rolled on her back, watching the ceiling. Adora kept stroking her arm, her fingers tracing the marks in Catra's fur.

"I had a nightmare. That He won. He got the Heart because I couldn't save you. The clones dragged me back to the… pool and I lost everything again."

Now it was her mismatched eyes becoming filled with tears as she recalled that feeling of helplessness and heartbreak. Her failure.

“Catra, it’s alright now. It was just a bad dream.”

Adora was quick to comfort her. Wiping away the tears just like she did for her mere moments ago.

“He’s gone. And soon the nightmares will be too.”

“Promise?” Catra said with a weak voice, managing to form a smile.

“Promise.” Adora’s reply was quick, resolute. “I’ll comfort you as many times as you’ll need me to. I am not leaving you behind ever again.”

Catra exhaled sharply, casting away the fear and doubt. She hugged Adora and was hugged back, her purring rising from deep inside her chest.

“Thanks. Anyway, we should sleep now that I got you as my protection from nightmares, princess, right?”

They both chuckled and exchanged a quick kiss before Adora spoke.

“Of course, you can count on me. Goodnight Catra.”

“Night, Adora.”

Catra slept quite soundly afterwards, guarded in the loving embrace of the person she loved the most. No more nightmares visited her that night. Both of them slept the best they had in a long time.

End Notes

Hello, I'm Cookie. She-Ra destroyed me emotionally to the point I stopped working on my original work for the sake of writing fanfictions.

This is my first ever fanfiction so honestly super nervous >w< I hope it was at least enjoyable enough that you read (or skipped here) to this point. Down here. At the page.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!